

IT Department internal briefing | September 2026

A Proposal on IT Investment Deliberation under the New Governance Model

The IT Department's new role — framing issues through the lens of commonality

What happens on a shared pasture

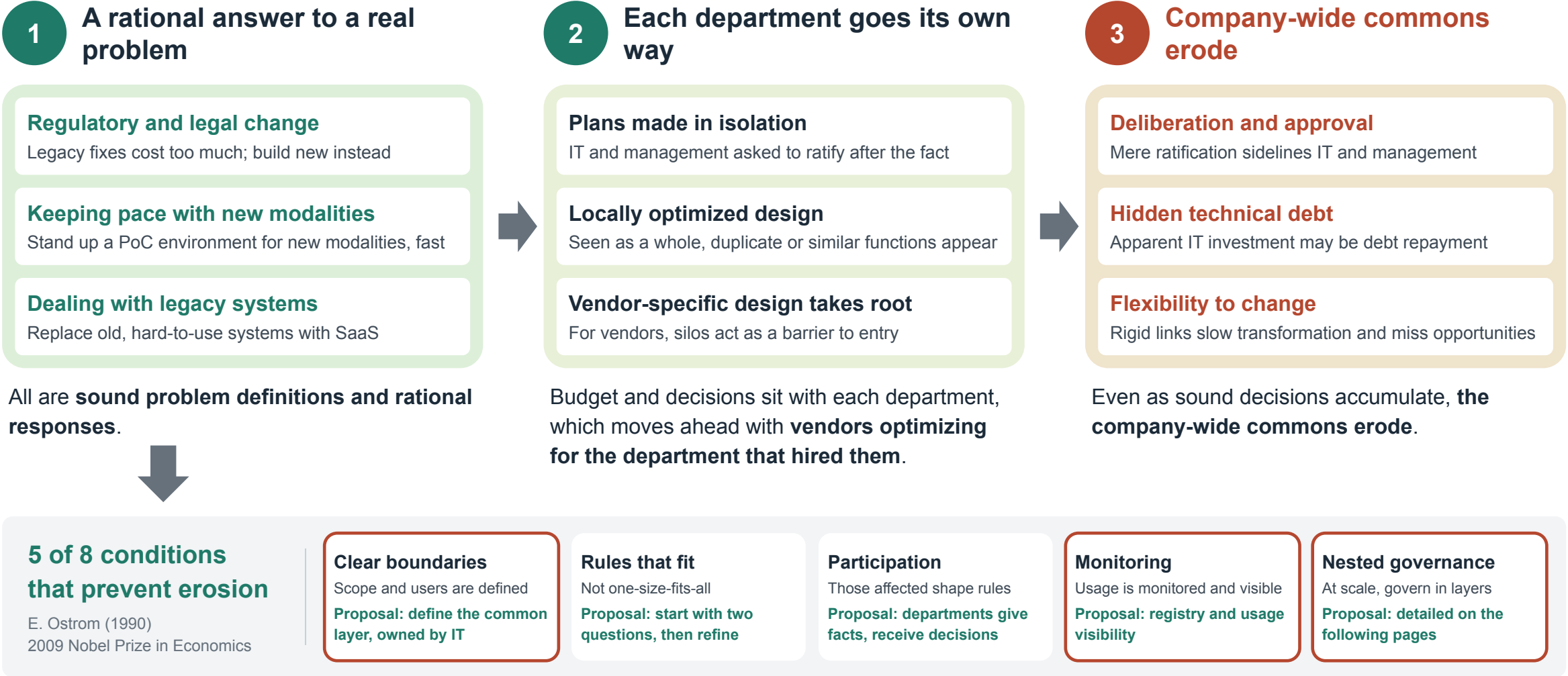


This is an "externality"

No one is at fault. The gain goes to the decision-maker; the loss spills over to everyone and to the future

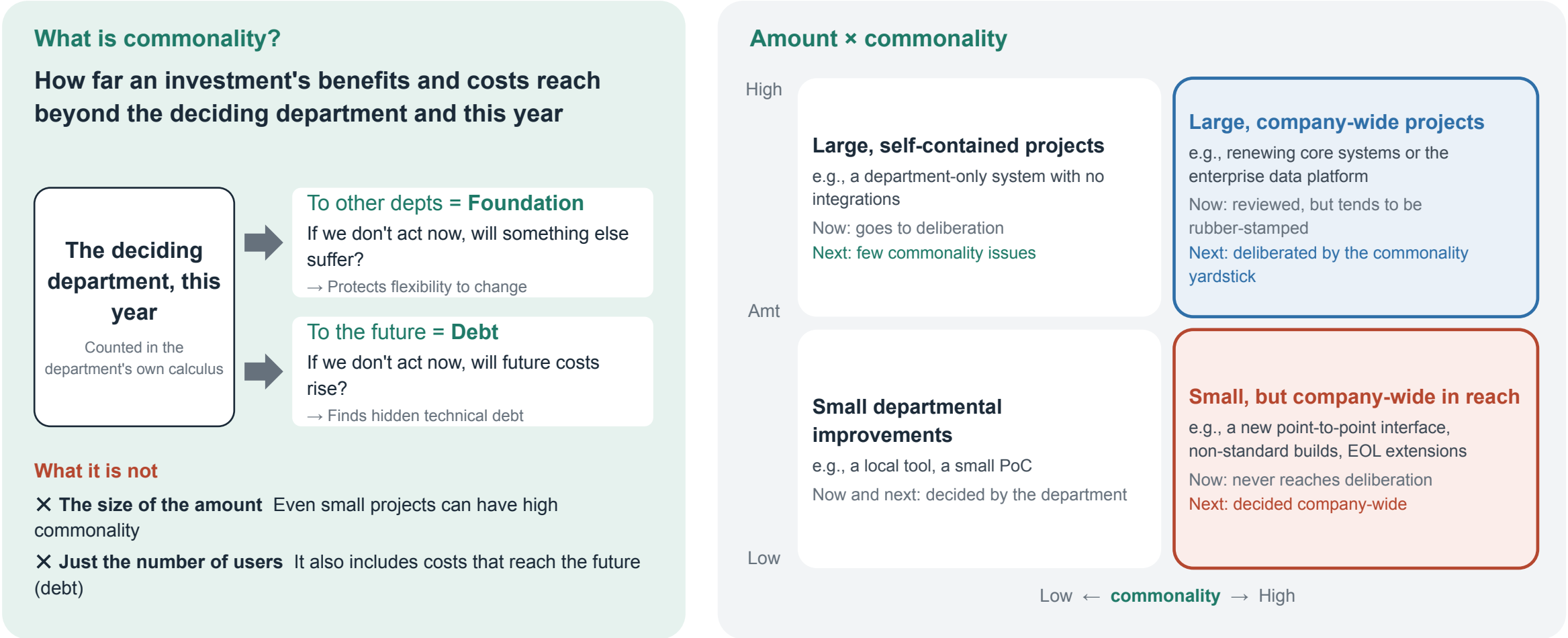
Even well-meant, rational decisions leave their impact on others out of the calculation. So we solve it with mechanisms, not appeals

What is happening in our IT



The key to nesting — sort what the company decides by commonality

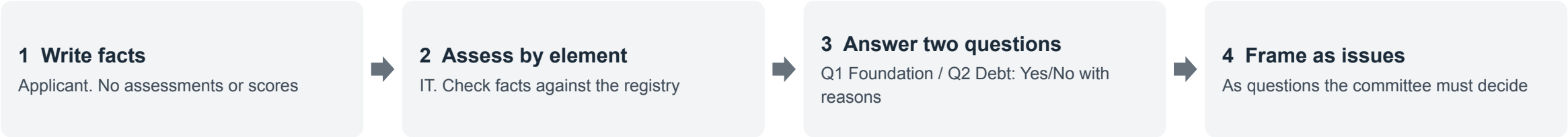
Today we sort by **amount** under the approval authority rules. Going forward, we also sort by **commonality**



Inside commonality — collect facts; IT assesses element by element

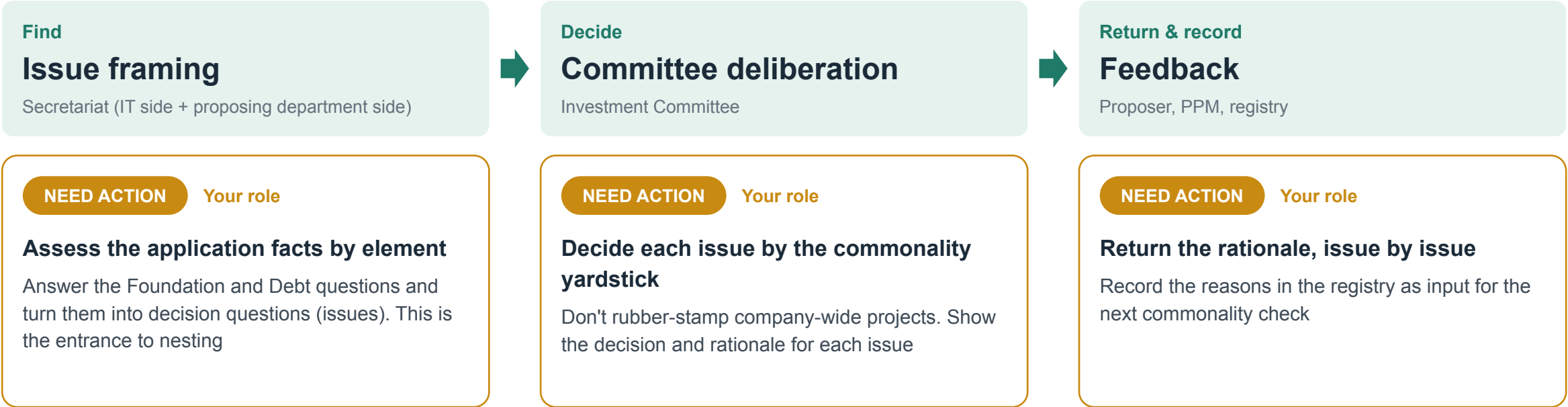
We don't ask applicants "Is Foundation OK?" We ask only for **facts**. Breaking facts into elements and assessing them is the job of **the IT Department**

	Element	Facts we ask the applicant	What IT assesses
Foundation Reaches other departments	Scope of benefit	User departments, number of users, target operations	Do benefits extend beyond the applying department?
	Connections	Existing systems and interface methods; data handled (master, enterprise data, etc.)	Does it touch key enterprise data or integrations? Can loose coupling be kept?
	Dependencies	Not asked. IT checks the dependency registry	Do other plans or systems depend on this investment?
Debt Reaches the future	Support end dates	New or renewal; support end date (EOL) of current products	Will deferral force emergency work after EOL? Is this investment itself debt repayment?
	Deviation from standards	Not asked. IT reads it from the architecture and interfaces	Does it deviate from enterprise technology, integration, or data standards?
	Duplication & siloed operation	Operation and maintenance setup, and contractors	Does a similar function already exist? Will siloed operation, changes, or later consolidation add future cost?



Where in the deliberation flow is commonality checked?

The entrance to nesting is **issue framing**. IT checks commonality and turns it into decision questions for the committee

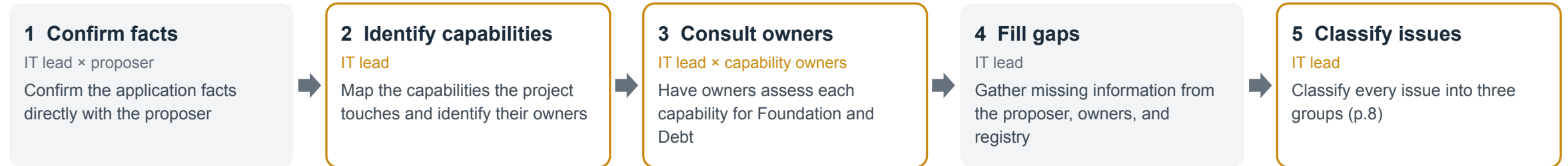


As nesting

Leave departmental matters to departments; decide company-wide only the issues with commonality
Commonality is found in issue framing, decided in deliberation, and recorded in the registry — checked in these three places

How to frame issues — consult capability owners and classify

Facts can be confirmed with the proposer. Commonality issues are framed with **the IT members who own the relevant capabilities**

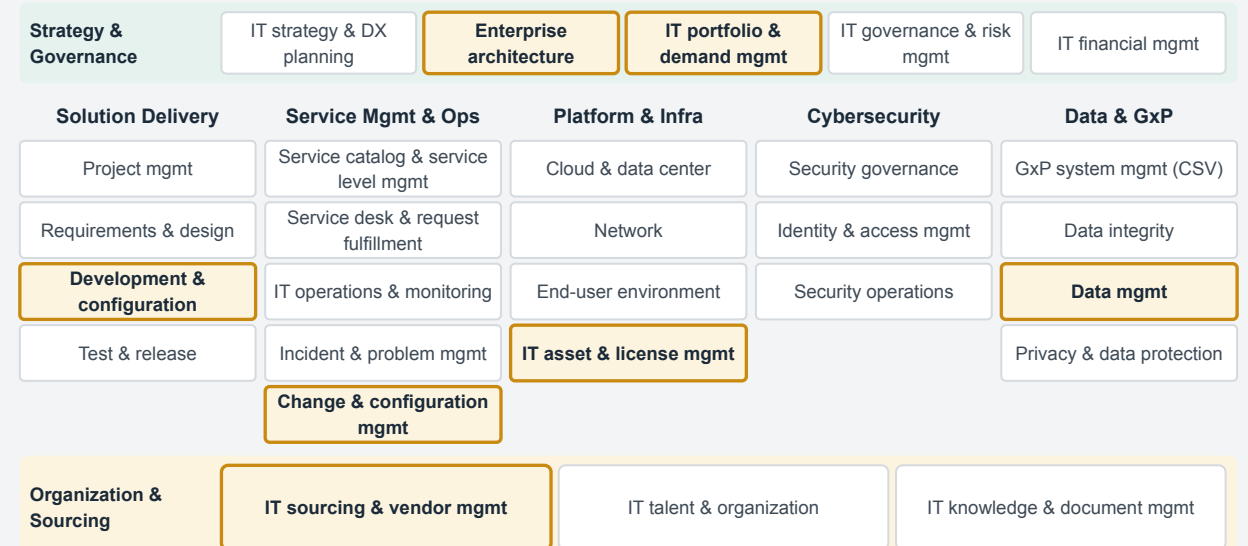


Commonality elements and capabilities to consult (examples)

Scope of benefit	Demand mgmt, application portfolio mgmt
Connections	System integration, master data mgmt
Dependencies	Architecture design (as-is / to-be)
Support end dates	Software license & SaaS mgmt, configuration mgmt
Deviation from standards	Technology standards & architecture review
Duplication & siloed operation	Application portfolio mgmt, supplier evaluation & oversight

Green = Foundation, red = Debt. Names are L3 of the capability map

Capability map (simplified, L2) ■ Capabilities consulted (left)



Classify issues into three and hand them to the committee

At the end of issue framing (p.7), classify every issue into one of these three. Each is written differently in the issue brief

Issues for deliberation

What they are

Related to commonality, and still needing a company-wide decision after consulting owners

How to write them in the issue brief

As decision questions ("We need to decide ...").
Separate facts from assessments

Examples

- Build as a company-wide platform, or keep it departmental?
- Accept a non-standard interface or data definition?
- Consolidate with a similar function elsewhere, or keep it separate?
- Renew a product nearing EOL now?
- Align timing and scope with dependent plans?

Issues reported as confirmed

What they are

Related to commonality, but confirmed with owners as posing no problem

How to write them in the issue brief

State which owners confirmed, and what they confirmed

Examples

- Connects via the standard interface (confirmed with the integration owner)
- Only references existing master data; no new definitions (confirmed with the MDM owner)
- Adopts products within support (confirmed with the license owner)

Not issues (decided within the department)

What they are

Unrelated to commonality; decided within the proposing department

How to write them in the issue brief

Share resolved items as information. Just note unresolved ones. If advice is wanted, say so

Examples

- Business requirements and feature priorities
- Cost-effectiveness within the department
- Vendor selection, schedule, and team

Check Did you note issues you considered but did not raise, and why? For issues reported as confirmed, did you state who confirmed what?

Take part in deliberation and feed back the results properly

Don't stop at approval. Return the rationale to the proposer, PPM, and the registry

Take part in deliberation

Decide issue by issue

Read the issue brief in advance; give a decision and rationale for each issue

Separate valid grounds

Treat management expectations as preconditions, not as grounds for approval

Record decisions

Record who decided which issue, and how

Return the results

Return the reasoning

In the response, return the reasoning for each issue, not just the conclusion

Use business language

Avoid economics jargon and phrases like "based on the framework"

Hand over to the next owner

Pass approval conditions to PPM; record the reasons in the registry

Sample response wording

Our decision rests on two points: **"how many departments and initiatives need this platform"** and **"how much extra cost we will incur later if we don't build it now"**.

Because the benefits extend beyond HR, we deliberated it as a company-wide matter.

A word to the proposer If you need extra work from the proposer, say so; if not, write "This does not require any additional work from the proposer."

Summary: what this deck set out to convey

1

Sound decisions can still erode the commons

Even sound, rational individual decisions erode the company-wide commons when externalities exist. Three things are eroding: deliberation and approval (vertical links), hidden technical debt, and flexibility to change (horizontal links)

2

Build nested governance with commonality

The tragedy is not inevitable (Ostrom). What we lack most is nested governance. The key: sort what departments and the company decide by commonality as well as amount, seen through Foundation and Debt

3

Start framing issues through the lens of commonality

If you agree with 1 and 2, we want to start framing IT investment issues through the commonality lens, and build the mechanisms to support it